

Day 1 — What is Auṣadhi?

Module: Herbs — Auṣadhi · **Band:** Senior · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will: define auṣadhi and recognise the six herbs of this module.

Materials

- Whiteboard / chart paper
- Notebook, pen per student
- (See lesson-plan.md for any day-specific materials)

Vocabulary introduced today

- *auṣadhi* (IAST: auṣadhi; lit. “medicinal plant / herb”)

Primary source (today’s reading)

From *Caraka Saṁhitā* — see `sources.md`.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- Daily check-in: one-sentence response to “*What’s one thing you remember about yesterday’s lesson?*”
- Hook: introduce a phenomenon or question that motivates today’s concept.

Core (20 min)

1. **Define *auṣadhi*.** Sanskrit for “medicinal plant” — broader than English “herb.” Includes leaves, roots, barks, seeds, resins. Distinguish from *ahara* (food) and *rasāyana* (rejuvenative).
2. **Six herbs we’ll study.** Show samples: Tulsi, Neem, Turmeric, Ginger, Ajwain, Mint. Pass them around for sight + smell.
3. **The traditional framework.** Each herb has *rasa* (taste), *vīrya* (potency — heating/cooling), *vipāka* (post-digestive effect), and *prabhāva* (specific action). This is the basic *dravyaguṇa* (pharmacology) of Āyurveda.
4. **Source.** Caraka Saṁhitā, Sūtrasthāna 1: “*There is nothing in the world that, applied at the right time and place, is not medicine.*” Read aloud.
5. **The critical caveat, repeated three times.** This module teaches IDENTIFICATION and traditional uses. It does NOT teach therapeutic dosing. Therapeutic use requires a qualified practitioner. State this rule prominently in workbooks.

Activity (15 min)

A scaled version of *Blind Smell-Test Identification* (see [activities/](#)). Today's slice: focus on the part of the activity that reinforces What is Auṣadhi?.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- One-sentence exit ticket: “*What’s one thing you learned today?*”
- Preview tomorrow.

Homework

(See `homework.md` for today’s task.)

Differentiation

- **Extension:** offer one open question or extra problem for fast finishers.
- **Support:** pair students who need scaffolds; offer partial outlines.

Teacher notes

- Citations: at least one quoted verse with citation per module. Day 1 already includes one if applicable; you may add more.
- Connect to prior modules where natural (especially Module 2 pañcabhūta).